foreseeable future, security bodies would continue to be perceived as central and necessary institutions, perhaps even the most important in Israeli society, but in 1996 we saw the following trends as likely to emerge:

1. A more critical public view of the security bodies, a growing demand for their transparency, aggressive media scrutiny, and decreased willingness to approve budgets
2. A growing devaluation of the field of security in its previous form and as a “national mission”
3. A view of the Mossad as “just another place of work” rather than as a “way of life”
4. The need for security services, including the Mossad, to compete with other employers in the labor market, though the material rewards they had to offer were smaller
5. Relocation abroad, a regular part of the Mossad’s work, being seen as a burden and as something forced

Twenty years after these predictions, one can marvel at the accuracy with which Forum 2000 identified future trends. Even more striking were the Forum’s 1996 predictions with regard to the challenges and future development of technology:

1. The dominance of technological means and capabilities in the Mossad would increase.
2. Many more significant pieces of intelligence would be collected using sophisticated technological means.
3. Visual intelligence (VISINT) would become an important collection tool.
4. Global and regional databases in computer networks would be commonplace and widely available.
5. Access to communication systems and databases would require dealing with complex protocols as well as encryption mechanisms.
6. Access to large quantities of information would require the use of smart filters. The filtering of textual material will not suffice; the